

Internal Revenue Service

Department of the Treasury • Internal Revenue Service • Kansas City, MO 64999-0025

Notice CP87A

Notice	CP87A	Tax year	2025
Notice date	April 20, 2026	Taxpayer ID	XXX-XX-9286
To	Ngozi Balogun	Caller ID	548291
Page	1 of 1 (plus enclosures)	Contact	1-800-829-0922

Ngozi Balogun

218 Lafayette St, Apt 4B

Newark, NJ 07105

Why you are receiving this notice

We received a 2025 tax return from another taxpayer that lists a dependent with the same Social Security number that you listed on your 2025 return. The Social Security number we are concerned about ends in 5510. Because the same Social Security number was used on more than one return, your return is being reviewed and any refund may be delayed.

What you need to do

Review whether you are entitled to list this dependent on your return under the rules for claiming a dependent.

If...	Then...
You ARE entitled to list this dependent	You do not need to respond to this notice or send us anything. Keep your records. We may contact you later and ask you to provide documents.
You are NOT entitled to list this dependent	File an amended return (Form 1040-X) to remove the dependent and any related amounts, and pay any additional tax you owe to limit interest and penalties.

This notice does not, by itself, determine who is entitled to list the dependent. By law, we cannot tell you the name of the other person who used the same Social Security number.

What happens if no one amends

If neither taxpayer files an amended return to remove the dependent, we may review both returns. If we do, you will receive a separate letter that begins the review and explains what to provide and by when. The taxpayer who is not entitled to list the dependent may owe additional tax, interest, and penalties; the other taxpayer's return and any related refund are then processed.

Because resolving this can take time, we may hold all or part of a refund associated with the dependent until the matter is resolved. Responding promptly, if we ask, and keeping good records help the process move more quickly.

If We Ask You for Documentation

You do not need to send anything in response to this notice unless we request it. If we later send a letter asking for documentation, you may be asked to provide records that support your eligibility to list the dependent. Keep your records with your tax documents. Send copies, not originals, and keep a copy of everything you send.

How to Amend Your Return (Form 1040-X)

If you determine you need to correct your return, file Form 1040-X, Amended U.S. Individual Income Tax Return. On the form, make the correction, explain the change, and figure any additional tax. You can file Form 1040-X electronically for many tax years, or mail it to the address in the form instructions. Keep a copy with your records. If you are entitled to list the dependent, you do not need to file Form 1040-X in response to this notice.

If You Owe Additional Tax

If you amend and owe additional tax, pay as much as you can when you file to limit interest and penalties. Interest accrues on unpaid tax from the original due date of the return until it is paid in full. If you cannot pay in full, payment options may include an online payment plan or installment agreement at www.irs.gov/payments.

Penalties and Interest

If a return is changed, additional tax may be subject to interest and, in some cases, penalties such as an accuracy-related penalty or a failure-to-pay penalty. Interest is charged at a rate set quarterly. If you are entitled to the items you reported, these do not apply to you. Reasonable-cause relief may be available in some situations.

If Your Return Is Selected for Examination

If the matter is not resolved by an amended return, the IRS may examine the affected returns. An examination verifies that the items reported are correct. You will receive a letter explaining what is being reviewed and the deadline to respond; many such reviews are handled by mail. You may represent yourself or have an authorized representative.

At the end of an examination, the IRS explains any proposed change. If you agree, you can sign and, if you owe, arrange payment. If you do not agree, you have appeal rights described below.

Your Appeal Rights

If you do not agree with a proposed change, you generally have the right to request a conference with the IRS Independent Office of Appeals, which is separate from the office that proposed the change. Any letter you receive will explain how and by when to request an appeal. Appeals offers an informal, impartial review and aims to resolve disputes without litigation. If you still disagree, you may be able to take your case to court.

The Taxpayer Bill of Rights

Every taxpayer has a set of fundamental rights when dealing with the IRS, known as the Taxpayer Bill of Rights:

The Right to Be Informed. Know what you need to do to comply with the tax laws and receive clear explanations of the laws and IRS procedures in notices and correspondence.

The Right to Quality Service. Receive prompt, courteous, and professional assistance and clear communications.

The Right to Pay No More than the Correct Amount of Tax. Pay only the amount legally due, including interest and penalties, and have the IRS apply all payments properly.

The Right to Challenge the IRS's Position and Be Heard. Raise objections and provide additional documentation in response to IRS actions, and have the IRS consider your timely objections.

The Right to Appeal an IRS Decision in an Independent Forum. Receive a fair and impartial administrative appeal of most IRS decisions, and generally take your case to court.

The Right to Finality. Know the maximum time to challenge a position and the maximum time the IRS has to audit a tax year or collect a tax debt.

The Right to Privacy. Expect that IRS inquiries, examinations, and enforcement will comply with the law and be no more intrusive than necessary.

The Right to Confidentiality. Expect that your tax information will remain confidential and not be disclosed unless authorized by you or by law.

The Right to Retain Representation. Retain an authorized representative of your choice to represent you in dealings with the IRS.

The Right to a Fair and Just Tax System. Expect the tax system to consider facts and circumstances that might affect your liabilities, ability to pay, or ability to provide information timely.

Understanding Notices and Letters from the IRS

The IRS sends notices and letters for many reasons. Each notice has a number (this one is CP87A) printed at the top, along with the tax year and what it is about. Read the entire notice carefully so you understand what, if anything, you need to do and by when. Keep every notice with your tax records.

If a notice asks you to respond, note the deadline and respond on time. If you disagree, follow the instructions for explaining why and providing documentation. Most issues can be resolved by mail or online without visiting an office.

Protecting Yourself from Tax Scams

The IRS will not call to demand immediate payment using a specific method such as a gift card or wire transfer, threaten to bring in police to arrest you, demand payment without giving you the chance to question or appeal, or ask for card numbers over the phone. The IRS generally first contacts taxpayers by mail.

Be cautious of emails, texts, or social-media messages claiming to be from the IRS; these may be attempts to steal your information. Do not click links or provide personal information in response. If unsure whether a notice or call is legitimate, verify through your IRS Online Account or by calling a number from www.irs.gov.

Identity Theft

In some cases a Social Security number may be used on another return because of identity theft. If you believe your or a dependent's information was used fraudulently, you can respond to IRS notices, file Form 14039 (Identity Theft Affidavit) if appropriate, and consider requesting an Identity Protection PIN. Keep copies of all correspondence.

Online Tools and How to Reach Us

At www.irs.gov you can check your refund status with 'Where's My Refund?', view your account and balance, set up a payment plan, get tax records (transcripts), and obtain an Identity Protection PIN. Create or sign in to your IRS Online Account for secure access. If you call, have this notice and your tax return available.

Free Help and the Taxpayer Advocate Service

Resource	Contact
Questions about this notice	1-800-829-0922 (have this notice with you)
IRS general assistance	1-800-829-1040 • www.irs.gov
Refund status	'Where's My Refund?' at irs.gov/refunds or the IRS2Go app

Resource	Contact
Free tax preparation (eligible taxpayers)	Volunteer Income Tax Assistance (VITA): 1-800-906-9887
Low Income Taxpayer Clinics	Independent clinics that may help resolve disputes with the IRS
Taxpayer Advocate Service	An independent organization within the IRS: 1-877-777-4778

The Taxpayer Advocate Service (TAS) may be able to help if your tax problem is causing financial difficulty or if you have been unable to resolve it through normal channels. Low Income Taxpayer Clinics are independent of the IRS and may assist eligible taxpayers, often for free or a small fee.

Accessibility and Language Services

The IRS provides tax information in several languages and offers services for taxpayers with disabilities, including notices in alternative formats such as Braille, large print, and accessible electronic formats upon request. To request an alternative format, call the number on this notice. If you need assistance in a language other than English, interpreter services are available at no cost to you.

Recordkeeping

Keep copies of your filed tax returns and any notices you receive. As a general rule, keep tax records for at least three years from the date you filed your return, and longer in certain situations. Store records securely and shred documents that contain Social Security numbers when you no longer need them.

Authorizing a Representative

You may authorize someone to represent you before the IRS or to receive your tax information. To authorize a representative to act on your behalf, file Form 2848, Power of Attorney and Declaration of Representative. To authorize someone only to receive or inspect your tax information, file Form 8821, Tax Information Authorization. You may revoke an authorization at any time.

Glossary

Term	Definition
Notice	A written communication from the IRS about your account or return.
Amended return	A corrected return filed on Form 1040-X.
Examination	An IRS review to verify items reported on a return.

Term	Definition
Appeal	A request for an independent review of a proposed IRS change.
Transcript	An IRS record summarizing your return or account information.
Identity Protection PIN	A number that helps prevent someone from filing a return using your Social Security number.
Installment agreement	An arrangement to pay tax you owe over time.
Power of attorney	An authorization (Form 2848) allowing a representative to act on your behalf.

Understanding Your Refund

If you are due a refund, the fastest way to receive it is to file electronically and choose direct deposit. Most refunds are issued within 21 days of e-filing, but some take longer if a return needs additional review, as may happen when an item on the return is being verified. You can check the status of your refund with the 'Where's My Refund?' tool about 24 hours after e-filing or four weeks after mailing a paper return.

Part or all of a refund may be applied to certain past-due debts you owe, such as federal tax, state income tax, child support, or other federal debts, under the Treasury Offset Program. If an offset occurs, you will receive a notice explaining the amount and the agency that received it.

How to Make a Payment

If you owe tax, you can pay online, by phone, by mail, or in person. Online options at www.irs.gov/payments include IRS Direct Pay from a bank account at no cost, payment by debit or credit card (a processing fee applies), and scheduling a payment from your IRS Online Account.

Payment method	Notes
IRS Direct Pay	Free; directly from your checking or savings account
Debit/credit card	Processed by a third party; a fee applies
Electronic Federal Tax Payment System	Free; enrollment required; good for scheduling
Check or money order	Payable to 'United States Treasury'; include the notice number
Online payment plan	Apply at irs.gov/paymentplan if you cannot pay in full

Always include your taxpayer identification number and the tax year on any payment so it is applied correctly.

If You Cannot Pay What You Owe

If you cannot pay the full amount, pay as much as you can to reduce interest and penalties, then consider a payment option. Many taxpayers qualify to apply online for a short-term extension to pay or a longer-term installment agreement. In limited circumstances, an Offer in Compromise may allow you to settle for less than the full amount, and the IRS may temporarily delay collection if you are experiencing hardship. Interest and some penalties continue to accrue until the balance is paid.

Interest and How It Is Charged or Paid

Interest is charged on tax not paid by the due date and is compounded daily at a rate set each calendar quarter. If the IRS owes you a refund and does not pay it within a set period, the IRS may pay you interest. Interest the IRS pays you is taxable and is reported to you after year-end.

Responding to an IRS Letter — General Guidance

If you receive a letter that asks for a response, read it carefully and note the deadline. Gather the documents the letter requests, write a clear explanation, and include a copy of the letter and your daytime phone number. Send copies rather than originals and keep a copy of everything you send. Respond by the deadline to protect your rights; if you need more time, contact the IRS at the number on the letter to ask for an extension.

If you agree with a proposed change, follow the instructions to sign and return the response and to pay any amount due. If you disagree, explain why and provide supporting documents. Most matters can be resolved by mail.

What to Expect in a Correspondence Examination

A correspondence examination is conducted by mail rather than in person. The IRS sends a letter identifying the items under review and the documentation needed. You send copies of your records by the deadline, and the IRS reviews them and sends its determination. If you need help, you may authorize a representative.

Keep organized records so you can respond quickly. If you do not respond, the IRS may make changes based on the information it has, which could increase the tax you owe. You retain the right to appeal a proposed change.

Getting a Copy of Your Return or a Transcript

You can get a free tax transcript - a summary of your return or account information - through your IRS Online Account, by using the Get Transcript tool at www.irs.gov, or by filing Form 4506-T. A transcript is often sufficient for verifying income or resolving an account question. If you need an exact copy of a previously filed return, file Form 4506; a fee applies and processing can take several weeks.

Free Ways to Prepare and File

Eligible taxpayers can prepare and file federal returns at no cost. IRS Free File offers free guided tax software for taxpayers below an income threshold and free fillable forms for others. The Volunteer Income Tax Assistance (VITA) and Tax Counseling for the Elderly (TCE) programs offer free in-person help to those who qualify, including people with limited income, persons with disabilities, and taxpayers who speak English as a second language.

If You Move or Change Your Name

Notify the IRS if you move so you receive refunds and correspondence. You can change your address by using your IRS Online Account, filing Form 8822, writing to the IRS, or noting the new address on your next return. If your name changes, report it to the Social Security Administration so the name on your tax return matches their records and your return is not delayed.

Keeping Your Tax Information Secure

Protect your Social Security number and tax records. Do not carry your Social Security card unless necessary, be cautious about sharing personal information, and use strong, unique passwords for online accounts. Consider requesting an Identity Protection PIN, which adds a layer of security to your federal tax filing. Shred documents containing personal information when you no longer need them.

How the IRS Will Contact You

The IRS usually first contacts taxpayers by mail delivered by the U.S. Postal Service. The IRS does not initiate contact by email, text message, or social media to request personal or financial information. In limited situations the IRS may call or visit, but it will not demand immediate payment by an unusual method or threaten to involve law enforcement. When in doubt, verify by calling a number listed at www.irs.gov.

More Definitions

Term	Definition
Direct deposit	Electronic delivery of a refund to your bank account.
Treasury Offset Program	A program that applies certain refunds to past-due debts.
Installment agreement	An arrangement to pay tax you owe over time.
Offer in Compromise	An agreement that may settle a tax debt for less than the full amount in limited cases.

Term	Definition
Transcript	An IRS record summarizing return or account information.
Correspondence examination	An IRS review conducted by mail.
Statute of limitations	The time limit for the IRS to audit a return or collect a tax.
Estimated tax	Periodic tax payments on income not subject to withholding.

Estimated Tax and Withholding

Federal income tax is a pay-as-you-go tax. Most people pay through withholding from wages; others pay through quarterly estimated tax payments on income not subject to withholding. If you receive a large refund or owe a balance when you file, you may want to adjust your withholding by giving your employer a new Form W-4, or adjust your estimated payments. The IRS Tax Withholding Estimator at www.irs.gov can help you check whether your withholding matches your expected tax.

Paying too little during the year can result in an underpayment, and a penalty may apply. Paying the correct amount during the year avoids both a large balance due and an interest-free loan to the government in the form of an oversized refund.

Understanding Your IRS Online Account

An IRS Online Account lets you securely view key information: your payoff amount and balance by year, your payment history, your tax records and transcripts, digital copies of certain notices, and your Economic Impact and advance payment information when applicable. You can also make payments, set up payment plans, and obtain an Identity Protection PIN. Creating an account requires verifying your identity through a secure process.

Amended Returns — Additional Detail

File Form 1040-X to correct a previously filed return, for example to change income, deductions, credits, filing status, or dependents. Generally, to claim a refund you must file Form 1040-X within three years after the date you filed the original return or within two years after the date you paid the tax, whichever is later. Attach any forms or schedules affected by the change. If you are amending for more than one year, file a separate Form 1040-X for each year. Track the status of an amended return with the 'Where's My Amended Return?' tool.

Penalties — Additional Detail

Penalty	When it may apply
Failure to file	Filing a return after the due date without an extension or reasonable cause
Failure to pay	Not paying tax shown as due by the due date
Accuracy-related	A substantial understatement of tax or negligence
Estimated tax (underpayment)	Not paying enough tax during the year through withholding or estimates
Erroneous claim for refund	An excessive refund or credit claim without a reasonable basis

Penalties may be reduced or removed if you can show reasonable cause for the failure or qualify for first-time penalty abatement. Interest on a penalty generally continues until the penalty is paid.

The Collection Process (Overview)

If you have a balance due and do not pay it or arrange to pay it, the IRS may begin collection actions. The process generally starts with notices requesting payment. If the balance remains unpaid, the IRS may file a Notice of Federal Tax Lien or, after further notice and your right to a hearing, levy certain assets or wages. Setting up a payment plan or otherwise resolving the balance generally stops further collection action. You have appeal rights at several points in the process.

Appeals — Additional Detail

The IRS Independent Office of Appeals provides taxpayers an opportunity to resolve disputes without going to court. Appeals is independent of the IRS office that made the determination and considers the facts, the law, and the hazards of litigation. To request an appeal, follow the instructions in the letter proposing the change, generally by submitting a written protest by the stated deadline. You may represent yourself or be represented by an authorized person. If you do not reach agreement with Appeals, you may have the right to take your case to the U.S. Tax Court or another court.

How Long to Keep Records

Keep records that support income, deductions, and credits on your return until the period of limitations for that return runs out. Generally that is three years from the date you filed, but keep records longer in certain situations - for example, six years if income was substantially understated, and indefinitely if a return was not filed. Keep records related to property until the period of limitations expires for the year in which you dispose of the property.

Common IRS Notices (Reference)

Notice	General purpose
CP87A	Verify a dependent claimed on more than one return
CP2000	Proposed changes because income or payment information does not match
CP14	You have a balance due
CP49	Your refund was applied to a balance you owe
CP11 / CP12	Changes were made to your return that affect your balance or refund
Letter 5071C	Identity verification needed before processing your return
CP501 / CP503 / CP504	Reminders and notices of a balance due

This reference is general. Always follow the specific instructions on any notice you receive.

Benefits of Electronic Filing

Filing electronically is the fastest, most accurate way to file. E-file software checks for common errors, confirms the IRS received your return, and, combined with direct deposit, delivers refunds faster than paper filing. If you owe, you can e-file early and schedule your payment for the due date. Eligible taxpayers can e-file for free through IRS Free File.

Refund Delivery Options

You can have a refund deposited directly into one account or split among up to three accounts using Form 8888; deposited to a prepaid debit card or certain mobile apps that accept direct deposit; or mailed as a paper check. Direct deposit is faster and more secure than a paper check. Double-check your routing and account numbers, because an incorrect number can delay your refund.

Estimated Tax Due Dates

Payment period	Generally due
January 1 - March 31	April 15
April 1 - May 31	June 15
June 1 - August 31	September 15
September 1 - December 31	January 15 of the following year

If a due date falls on a weekend or legal holiday, the payment is due the next business day. These dates apply to estimated tax and are provided for general reference.

Your Responsibilities as a Taxpayer

Along with your rights, you have responsibilities: to file accurate and complete returns on time, to pay the tax you owe by the due date, to keep adequate records to support the items on your returns, to respond to IRS notices by their deadlines, and to keep your address and other information current with the IRS. Meeting these responsibilities helps you avoid penalties and resolve questions quickly.

Innocent Spouse and Injured Spouse Relief (General)

These provisions apply to married taxpayers and are summarized for general awareness. Innocent spouse relief may relieve you of responsibility for tax, interest, and penalties if your spouse or former spouse improperly reported or omitted items on a joint return. Injured spouse relief (Form 8379) may let you recover your share of a joint refund that was applied to your spouse's separate past-due debt. Specific rules and time limits apply; see the relevant form instructions.

Interest Rate Reference (General)

The IRS sets interest rates quarterly. Interest on underpayments is generally the federal short-term rate plus three percentage points, and it compounds daily. Interest the IRS pays on certain overpayments is set under the same general framework. Because rates change each quarter and interest compounds daily, the amount of interest on a balance changes over time. Current rates are published at www.irs.gov.

Contact Directory

Purpose	Contact
Questions about this notice	1-800-829-0922
Individual tax assistance	1-800-829-1040
Order forms and publications	1-800-829-3676 • www.irs.gov/forms
Refund status	www.irs.gov/refunds • IRS2Go app
Identity Protection PIN	www.irs.gov/ippin
Taxpayer Advocate Service	1-877-777-4778

Purpose	Contact
Report tax scams / phishing	phishing@irs.gov
Written correspondence	Use the address printed at the top of this notice

Final Reminders

Read this notice in full and keep it with your tax records. If you are entitled to list the dependent shown, you do not need to respond. If you are not entitled, file an amended return and pay any tax due. If you later receive a letter requesting documentation, respond by the deadline. If you need help, use the resources listed in this notice, including the Taxpayer Advocate Service and Low Income Taxpayer Clinics for eligible taxpayers.

Continue to file and pay future taxes as usual while any review of this matter is pending.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q. How do I know this notice is really from the IRS?

Genuine IRS notices arrive by mail and include a notice number (here, CP87A), your truncated taxpayer identification number, and a contact number. You can verify a notice through your IRS Online Account or by calling a number listed at www.irs.gov.

Q. Do I have to respond to this notice?

Only if you determine you are not entitled to list the dependent, in which case you file an amended return. If you are entitled, keep your records; no response is required unless we later request documentation.

Q. What if I already filed an amended return?

If you have already corrected your return, no further action is needed in response to this notice. You can track an amended return with the 'Where's My Amended Return?' tool.

Q. How long will this take to resolve?

Timeframes vary. If a review begins, the letter you receive will include deadlines. Responding promptly to any request and keeping good records help the process move more quickly.

Q. Can I get more time to respond if you ask for documents?

If a later letter requests documents and you need more time, contact the IRS at the number on that letter before the deadline to ask for an extension.

Q. Where do I send documents if requested?

Use the address or fax number printed on the letter that requests them. Include a copy of the letter and your daytime phone number, and send copies rather than originals.

Q. Can someone represent me?

Yes. You may authorize a representative using Form 2848, or authorize someone to receive your tax information using Form 8821.

Q. Will this affect future years?

Each tax year is considered separately. Keeping accurate records each year helps you respond if a similar question arises in the future.

Additional Definitions

Term	Definition
Filing deadline	The date by which a return is due, generally in mid-April for individual returns.
Extension to file	More time to file a return; it is not an extension of time to pay.
Withholding	Tax taken from pay or other income and sent to the IRS on your behalf.
Refund	The amount returned to you when your payments and credits exceed your tax.
Balance due	The amount you owe when your tax exceeds your payments and credits.
Levy	A legal seizure of property to satisfy a tax debt, used after notice and appeal rights.
Lien	A legal claim against your property to secure payment of a tax debt.
Reasonable cause	A basis for removing certain penalties when you exercised ordinary care but could not comply.

What This Notice Package Contains

This package includes the CP87A notice and general taxpayer information enclosures: what you need to do; what happens if no one amends; how to amend; payment options if you owe; penalties and interest; examination and appeal procedures; the Taxpayer Bill of Rights; how to recognize genuine IRS contact and avoid scams; identity-protection guidance; online tools and free-help resources; accessibility and language services; recordkeeping; and the Privacy Act and Paperwork Reduction Act notice. Keep the entire package with your records.

Privacy Act and Paperwork Reduction Act Notice

Our legal right to ask for information is found in Internal Revenue Code sections 6001, 6011, and 6012(a) and their regulations, which require you to file a return or statement for any tax for which you are liable. We use the

information to determine the correct amount of tax. We may give it to the Department of Justice and other federal agencies, to states under tax treaties or information-sharing agreements, and to others as authorized by law. Providing the information is mandatory.

You are not required to provide information requested on a form that is subject to the Paperwork Reduction Act unless the form displays a valid OMB control number. The time needed to comply with notices varies depending on individual circumstances. If you have comments about the accuracy of these time estimates or suggestions, you can write to the IRS at the address in the relevant form instructions.